



SWING CONNECTION

the power of dance in education

June 18 - 23, 2025 Terrassa



ABOUT THE PROJECT

Swing dance is a group of dance styles that originated in the United States in the 1920s and 1930s, inspired by swing jazz music. It is characterized by its energy, joyful rhythm, and dynamic movements.

Some of the most well-known styles within swing are:

Lindy Hop:

This is a social dance that emerged in the **1920s-1930s in the African American community of Harlem**, New York. It is danced in pairs and combines energetic movements, acrobatics, and a lot of play with swing music. It is a spontaneous and fun dance where connection with the partner and improvisation are key.



Solo Jazz:

Also known as Authentic Jazz, this is an individual dance style based on **the movements of the jazz era from the 1920s-1940s**. It includes steps like the Charleston, the Suzie Q, and the Shorty George. It is characterized by its expressiveness, rhythm, and freedom to play with the music.



Lindy Hop demonstration:

<https://youtu.be/6fDIPCuGpjE?si=J1PET2WSJOwWGYIx>

Solo Jazz demonstration:

<https://youtu.be/6fDIPCuGpjE?si=J1PET2WSJOwWGYIx>



OBJECTIVES

Swing is not just a dance style, but also a powerful tool for education and personal development. Through practical activities and reflection, we will explore how the values of **Lindy Hop** and **Solo Jazz** can be integrated into educational contexts, promoting social, emotional, and cultural competencies.



TOPICS

Rhythm and dynamic learning

Movement-based learning enhances memory, attention, and motivation, especially in alternative education methodologies. **During the training**, pedagogical activities will incorporate rhythm and dance to teach concepts in a more playful and interactive way, encouraging coordination and practical learning.

Emotional management and resilience

In swing, improvisation and constant adaptation help develop tolerance to frustration and resilience. **During the training**, exercises will be carried out to deal with mistakes and transform "failures" into learning opportunities in different educational settings.

Gender equality and new narratives in dance

Unlike other styles, in modern Lindy Hop, the roles of leader and follower are interchangeable, promoting more equal relationships. **The training** will offer the possibility of exploring both roles to promote gender equality and empowerment through dance.

Teamwork and shared leadership

Lindy Hop fosters cooperation in pairs (leader and follower), developing skills in communication, trust, and mutual respect. **During the training**, dynamic activities will be used to improve collaboration in student groups or youth programs focused on social inclusion.

Personal expression and self-esteem

Solo Jazz promotes creativity and exploring one's own style, which strengthens self-confidence and emotional well-being. **During the training**, improvisation exercises will be conducted to enhance body expression in classrooms or personal development workshops.

Inclusion and diversity

Swing was born from the blend of cultures (mainly African-American) and has always been an inclusive and diverse space. Its values can help break down social barriers. **During the training**, activities will be conducted where dance steps are used as metaphors for integration and adaptation in multicultural groups.



METHODOLOGY

With this training, participants will have the opportunity to:

- Participate in **practical swing dance workshops** linked to educational themes
- Engage in **reflection spaces** about the values of swing and its social impact
- **Create educational resources and materials** to apply in different contexts
- Participate in **dynamic presentations and performances** where participants will share their learnings



Thanks to this training, participants will not only learn to dance but also integrate swing as an educational tool and a means of social transformation in their own communities.

TOPICS

Uxue Martinez and **Gerard Nevot** are two dancers and teachers of Lindy Hop. They are references in Catalunya and also teach in international festivals in countries such as Ireland, Greece, Holland or France. Their vocation is teaching and already have experience in training for teachers. They are knowledgeable from other disciplines such as tango or African dances to complement their knowledge of dance and culture.

Here some examples of their dancing moments:

- International competition
- Teacher presentation

THE DANCE SCHOOL

Triple Step is a Swing dances academy located in Terrassa (Barcelona). He has taught more than 2000 people to dance **Lindy Hop and Solo Jazz** sharing the passion for jazz, swing and Afro -descendant culture. His pedagogical method is a reference in many communities and are pioneers to train people dedicated to **formal and non -formal education**.



PARTECIPANTS

Country	Number of participants
Spain (La Víbria)	3
Portugal	4
Greece	4
Lithuania	4
France	4
Italy	4
Germany	4
Spain	4

- This **training course** is aimed at people involved in **formal and non-formal education** who want to explore new pedagogical tools through dance and swing culture.
- **No prior dance experience is required**, as the training is designed for anyone interested in teaching and experiential learning.
- Participants will be able to apply the knowledge gained in their educational contexts.
- **Participants** can be teachers, trainers, youth leaders, or **anyone who uses dynamic methodologies in their educational profession** and wants to incorporate movement, music, and creativity as resources to promote values such as inclusion, self-esteem, teamwork, and diversity.





TRAVEL COST

Travel distance	Green travel	Non-green travel
10-99 km	56 Eur	28 eur
100-499 km	285 eur	211 eur
500-1999 km	417 eur	309 eur
2000-2999 km	535 eur	395 eur
3000-3999 km	785 eur	580 eur
4000-7999 km	1188 eur	1188 eur

- **Travel expenses** will be reimbursed to the sending organization max. 2 months after the project concludes.
- **DO NOT BUY** any tickets before receiving confirmation from the hosting organization! Participants must send the travel proposal to info@vibria.org. The team should only buy the tickets after confirmation, otherwise the tickets might not be reimbursable.
- You must travel in **the most efficient way available**: it is recommended to choose the cheapest and the greenest option for travel.
- Participants must keep and then **send ALL the travel documents in their original form**, including invoices, boarding passes, receipts or tickets they use during their travel. This is important for the reimbursement process to happen.
- Taxis cannot be reimbursed.
- In case of **green travel**, participants have 2 travel days for the arrival and another 2 travel days for the departure. We ask you to inform us in advance in case you want to use green travel.



HOW TO GET THERE

By plane

Take a plane until the "**Barcelona El Prat**" airport. Once there:

OPTION 1: *(from Terminal 1 and 2)*

- Take the Aerobus **A1** or **A2** to "**Plaça Catalunya**"
- Find the FGC Ferrocarrils station, buy a ticket to Terrassa and take the line **S1** until "**Terrassa Estació del Nord**"

OPTION 2: *(from Terminal 2)*

- Find the train station in Terminal 2
- Buy a ticket to **Terrassa**
- Take the train "**R2 Nord**" until "**Barcelona Sants**" station
- Change platform and take the train "**R4**" until "**Terrassa Estació del Nord**" station

Walk until the "**Alberg de Vallparadís**" (Carrer de Alcalde Parellada, 2), it's only 6 minutes away from the station.



By train

Take a train until "**Barcelona Sants**" station:

- In the station, find the part of the **RENFE** trains
- Buy a ticket to **Terrassa**
- Take the train "**R4**" until "**Terrassa Estació del Nord**" station

Walk until the "**Alberg de Vallparadís**" (Carrer de Alcalde Parellada, 2), it's only 6 minutes away from the station.

By bus

Take a bus until "**Barcelona d'Autobusos Nord**" station

- Go out of the station to find the metro/Renfe station "**Arc de Triomf**"
- Buy a **RENFE ticket to Terrassa** (not the same than metro ticket)
- Take the train "**R4**" until "**Terrassa Estació del Nord**" station

Walk until the "**Alberg de Vallparadís**" (Carrer de Alcalde Parellada, 2), it's only 6 minutes away from the station.

***Try to arrive before 20:00 CET so we can have a welcome dinner together.**



ACCOMODATION

"Alberg Vallparadís" is located close to the city center, in a quiet area.

It is surrounded by the largest local park, Vallparadís, which is ideal for walks, sport, and activities. The participants will be accommodated in shared rooms, separated by gender. The rooms are equipped with bed sheets and towels. There is a WiFi connection in the hostel.

Address: C/ Alcalde Parellada 2, Terrassa.



TERRASSA

Terrassa is located in the **province of Barcelona**, and is the **co-capital of Vallès Occidental**. With a population of **225.274** (2023), it's the **third biggest city** in Catalonia, after Barcelona and L'Hospitalet. Terrassa has been inhabited since prehistory. During Roman times it was known as **Egara** and there are still important remains from the Middle Ages. it was one of the **leading Spanish cities** of the **industrial revolution**, which really shaped the city.

There are a lot of **modernist buildings** from that time in the city, and some factories can still be found in the middle of residential neighbourhoods. Even if this is not the most touristic city of Catalonia, there are some interesting spots to see!



WHAT TO BRING

Everything that you will need to spend a few days out of home!

June in Terrassa is warm and pleasant, with temperatures ranging from 16°C to 28°C. Rain is rare, but occasional thunderstorms can occur. The days are long and sunny!

- Anything you might need to share an **intercultural moment** with traditional food, snacks, non-alcoholic drinks or souvenirs.
- **Personal hygiene items**: toothbrush and toothpaste, shampoo, shower gel, sunscreen, etc.
- Alberg Vallparadís provides bed linen and towels but there are no hairdryers.
- Reusable water bottle, to avoid plastic waste.
- It is mandatory to have a **medical insurance** (i.e. European HealthInsurance Card) during your travel. The host organisation will not cover any personal health costs. It is recommended to have valid travel insurance (not covered by the project).
- You're welcomed to bring any **card game, board game or activity to enjoy during the free time** and also to share with others during the evenings.
- For the activities, we recommend wearing **comfortable clothing and sneakers**.





ABOUT THE HOST

La **Víbria Intercultural** was founded in 2003 with the **mission** to **promote values of diversity and interculturality among young people and society** in general through **international mobility experiences** and sociocultural initiatives based on non-formal education. Since then, La Víbria works to motivate participation, active citizenship and encourage young people to develop critical thinking.



Advise on youth mobility

Our international mobility advisors help and guide youngsters to find opportunities abroad that fit their interests. We are present on 6 youth information points of the region.



Radio Víbria

Our radio studio is always open to discuss social topics, promote active participation and create community. Discover our podcasts here: <https://radiovibria.com/>



#Greenfluencers

This is a group of local youngsters that promote actions to create awareness about climate change and environmental issues.



Baumann Bar

We run a vibrant cultural bar at the centre, DJ's, concerts, exhibitions and intercultural evenings are taking place every week there.

CONTACT

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